Monthly JBV / Research Policy Digest

Generated: 2026-10-16 13:04 **Coverage**: 2026-12 to 2027-01 | Journal of Business Venturing (7); Research Policy (25) **Total papers**: 32 (32 with abstract, 32 with PDF)

Journal breakdown: - Journal of Business Venturing: 7 - Research Policy: 25

Table of Contents

Journal of Business Venturing

- Volume 42, Issue 1 | Published 2027-01 (7)

Research Policy

- Volume 56, Issue 1 | Published 2027-01 (2)
- Volume 55, Issue 10 | Published 2026-12 (23)

Journal of Business Venturing

Volume 42, Issue 1 | Published 2027-01

1. Co-founder selection from a marriage market perspective: How the dark triad shapes judgments of interpersonal attraction, resources, and equity demand

Authors: Yannick Nicolai Amend, Petrit Ademi, Matthew S. Wood, Monika Christine Schuhmacher

DOI: 10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106659 **Published**: 2027-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Entrepreneurship, Organizational Behavior, Social Psychology
- **Theories**: Marriage Market Theory, Dark Triad Personality Theory, Utility Theory

Abstract:

> Co-founder selection is a pivotal decision in new venture formation, yet how lead founders evaluate potential partners remains underexplored. Drawing on insights from marriage market theory, we conceptualize co-founder selection as an act of individuated judgment guided by cooperative logic and associated joint utility projection, wherein lead founders assess co-founder candidates based on social-emotional, instrumental, and distributive considerations reflected in interpersonal attraction, resource contributions, and equity demand. We further propose that lead founders' dark triad shifts this judgmental process from joint utility logic to personal utility maximization. Using a conjoint experiment with 206 entrepreneurs making 3296 co-founder selection decisions, we find that interpersonal attraction and resource contributions positively influence willingness to select a co-founder candidate, whereas higher equity demand reduces candidate attractiveness. Critically, lead founders higher in the dark triad display distinct patterns: they discount interpersonal attraction and display heightened sensitivity to equity dilution—assessments that indicate their prioritization of personal over joint value creation. Taken together, these findings reveal how dispositional tendencies influence the judgments underlying co-founder selection, indicating a shift away from the

> cooperative logic assumed in marriage market theory and co-founder selection toward greater emphasis on personal utility considerations. We discuss theoretical implications of these findings and offer practical guidance for navigating the complexities of co-founder selection.

Open PDF

---

2. Commons without borders: How entrepreneurs can engage local actors into collective action for the governance of supra-local common-pool resources

Authors: Coline Serres, Christina Hertel, Sophie Bacq

DOI: 10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106652 **Published**: 2027-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Sustainable Entrepreneurship, Institutional Entrepreneurship, Environmental Governance
- **Theories**: Collective Action Theory, Common-Pool Resource Theory, Institutional Theory

Abstract:

> Based on 41 interviews across three UK-based commons enterprises, this study addresses one of the most pressing challenges of our time: encouraging local actors to contribute to the sustainable governance of supra-local common-pool resources (CPRs)—shared resources whose use and impacts extend beyond community boundaries. While existing research has focused on locally bound natural CPRs, we lack understanding of how entrepreneurial ventures can mobilize the members of local communities to govern resources that span multiple jurisdictions. Our findings reveal a two-step process through which entrepreneurs first embed their commons enterprises in the local community, using asset locks and diversified engagement strategies to involve citizens, local businesses, and public authorities. Building on this embedding, three commoning practices emerge: collective learning about the CPR, collective action and capacity building for CPR stewardship, and collective institutionalization of CPR governance. Around these practices, a community of commoners emerges that is nested within the local community and increasingly sustains collective action independently of the entrepreneur. These practices anchor the supra-local CPR within the local community through three mechanisms: resource proximization, local conditionality, and bonding as a selective incentive, thereby overcoming the collective action barriers arising from lacking resource proximity and perceived responsibility. Our study contributes to research at the intersection of entrepreneurship and the commons by demonstrating the strategic role of common property regimes, shifting attention from the resource to the commoning practices and communities that form around it, and specifying the mechanisms that enable local collective action for supra-local CPR governance.

Open PDF

---

3. Corporate venturing in the digital era

Authors: Samuele Murtinu, Haemin Dennis Park, Christopher L. Tucci, Anu Wadhwa

DOI: 10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106653 **Published**: 2027-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Corporate Entrepreneurship, Digital Innovation, Strategic Management
- **Theories**: Knowledge-based View, Information Processing Theory

Abstract:

> Rapid technological advances in artificial intelligence and other digital technologies play a critical role in enabling established organizations to venture into new entrepreneurial opportunities. These advances present new challenges for corporate venturing (CV): how to organize, transfer information, and execute venturing activities as existing organizational structures and competencies become obsolete. This article introduces a framework for understanding how digital technologies reshape knowledge search in CV contexts under varying levels of environmental complexity, and proposes a typology of human-machine

> configurations that serves as a diagnostic tool for assessing the degree of machine autonomy in CV decisions. It further explores the opportunities and unintended consequences of these evolving digital venturing practices.

Open PDF

---

4. From breakdown to breakthrough: How entrepreneurs craft vulnerability narratives on social media

Authors: Gabriella Cacciotti, Marianna Marino, Deniz Ucbasaran, Ali Ahmed

DOI: 10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106656 **Published**: 2027-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Digital Entrepreneurship, Gender and Entrepreneurship, Entrepreneurial Communication
- **Theories**: Narrative Theory, Impression Management, Social Negotiation

Abstract:

> Entrepreneurial narratives are widely understood as strategic tools for building legitimacy and mobilizing resources. Yet we observed that some entrepreneurs openly share stories of fear, doubt, and struggle on social media - foregrounding emotional exposure rather than demonstrating strategic purpose. We conceptualize these as entrepreneurial vulnerability narratives: a distinct narrative form through which the lived consequences of entrepreneurial uncertainty are publicly shared and opened to social negotiation. These disclosures expose entrepreneurs to interpersonal risks, heightened for women entrepreneurs who contend with gendered biases and less supportive social contexts. To examine this phenomenon, we conducted interviews with 33 women entrepreneurs and a 21-month observation of their Instagram activity. Our analysis reveals that women entrepreneurs hold multiple and coexisting motivations for disclosure - self-oriented, relational, and normative - oscillating between them as needed, while developing narrative-crafting tactics that sustain the benefits of sharing while managing interpersonal risks. Our study contributes by theorizing entrepreneurial vulnerability narratives as a distinct narrative form; by challenging the view that entrepreneurial narratives serve primarily persuasive functions; and by showing how entrepreneurs actively construct precarious holding environments in fragmented digital contexts.

Open PDF

---

5. The judgment-based approach to entrepreneurship: The uncertainty–heterogeneity nexus

Authors: Nicolai J. Foss, Peter G. Klein, Carmen Elena Dorobat, Matthew McCaffrey, Mark D. Packard

DOI: 10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106660 **Published**: 2027-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Entrepreneurship, Strategic Management, Economics of the Firm
- **Theories**: Judgment-Based Approach, Knightian Uncertainty, Property Rights Theory, Resource-Based View

Abstract:

> The judgment-based approach (JBA) has emerged as an important contemporary perspective in management and entrepreneurship research. The JBA offers a distinctive theoretical account of entrepreneurship, centered on the formation and implementation of subjective theories of value creation under conditions of Knightian uncertainty, which highlights resource ownership, heterogeneous capital structure, organization and the firm, institutions, uncertainty, and the overarching need to appraise and coordinate all these factors using judgment. We present and develop the JBA by articulating the uncertainty–heterogeneity nexus, in which the joint presence of fundamental uncertainty and heterogeneous resources gives rise to the need for entrepreneurial judgment and makes its exercise economically consequential. Because judgment is subjective, tacit, and difficult to communicate or contract upon, entrepreneurs must rely on ownership and residual control rights to create value, linking judgment to the combination and deployment of resources, profit and loss, and organizational structure. The purpose of this article is threefold. First, we provide a systematic statement of the JBA as a theoretical framework, clarifying its core constructs, causal mechanisms, and domain of application. Second, we engage with key critiques and distinguish the JBA from

> related approaches, including opportunity-based, effectuation, and bricolage perspectives. Third, we outline directions for future research that build on the JBA's emphasis on judgment, ownership, and the organization and deployment of heterogeneous resources under uncertainty. By integrating these elements, we position the JBA as a coherent and distinctive theory of entrepreneurship with broad implications for research in management, organization, and strategy.

Open PDF

---

6. Who are my people and what can I do? Community remapping for entrepreneurial venturing after forced migration

Authors: Todd W. Moss, Trenton Alma Williams, Kurian George, Maria Minniti

DOI: 10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106654 **Published**: 2027-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Refugee Entrepreneurship, Crisis Management
- **Theories**: Sensemaking, Social Capital Theory, Contextualization

Abstract:

> Scholarship on post-disruption adaptation largely assumes conditions of partial disruption—situations where despite losing access to one or multiple domains, other important domains remain intact. Yet wholesale disruptions pose a qualitatively different challenge for entrepreneurship. We explore how experiences of wholesale disruption shape actors' reconstruction of their contextual structure, perceived scope of their entrepreneurial possibility space, and the long-term trajectory of their ventures. We conduct an inductive study of the venturing efforts of refugees following their wholesale disruption caused by forced migration to the USA. We develop a grounded theoretical model of community remapping for venturing after wholesale disruption that explains why some refugees enact dynamic, growing ventures while others enact more stable, static ventures and eschew growth aspirations. Our findings and theorizing contribute to literatures on venturing in response to wholesale disruptions and on refugee entrepreneurship.

Open PDF

---

7. Who will I be? Refugee entrepreneurship and founder identity

Authors: Eunki Ro, E. Erin Powell, Ted Baker

DOI: 10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106657 **Published**: 2027-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Refugee Entrepreneurship, Entrepreneurial Identity
- **Theories**: Founder Identity Theory, Social Identity Theory, Sensemaking

Abstract:

> We conducted a 27-month field study of 23 North Korean Defector (NKD) founders. Founders responded in three different ways to the disparaging default social identities they encountered by self-categorizing into three "avowed" social identities, which served as aspirations for how they would build their ventures. Founders generated sensemaking narratives that explained their behavior – to themselves and to others – by anchoring on the past, present, or future circumstances and claiming individual capabilities to build their ventures. The resulting ventures were characterized by distinctive missions, branding, and hiring preferences and therefore by patterned differences in the roles founders played. We contribute to scholarly understanding of refugee entrepreneurship by showing that the ways in which refugee founders respond to being in a new country and constructing new identities is more varied – because it is embedded in their responses to local social evaluations – than prior research has portrayed. We contribute to the development of founder identity theory (FIDT) by expanding prior understanding of how social identities drive founder role creation. Overall, we show the extension of refugee founder agency as they move from

> self-categorizing into avowed social identities to embedding themselves in the concrete social relations required to perform a role.

Open PDF

Research Policy

Volume 56, Issue 1 | Published 2027-01

1. External collaboration and local knowledge divergence in regional knowledge spaces

Authors: Jisoo Hur, Dieter F. Kogler, Keungoui Kim

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105641 **Published**: 2027-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Regional Innovation Systems, Economic Geography, Scientometrics, Knowledge Management
- **Theories**: Regional Innovation Systems Framework, Knowledge Recombination, Local Buzz and Global Pipelines, Evolutionary Economic Geography

Abstract:

> This study investigates the association between regional collaboration structures and the semantic position of locally produced scientific knowledge. Drawing on the Regional Innovation Systems framework, it distinguishes between intra-regional and inter-regional collaboration as complementary dimensions of scientific knowledge production. Using over nine million Web of Science publications from European regions between 1998 and 2021, this study employs semantic text embeddings to measure local knowledge divergence, defined as the semantic distance between each publication and the established regional knowledge base. Within the same region–field–period, externally collaborated publication groups exhibit slightly higher average local knowledge divergence than internally collaborated groups. However, the estimated difference is substantively negligible and varies across periods. The principal pooled-sample finding is an inverted U-shaped association between external collaboration share and regional local knowledge divergence, with the fitted curve reaching its maximum at an external collaboration share of approximately 45%. The realised magnitude of this association is modest, and heterogeneity analyses show that it is most pronounced in life sciences and biomedicine and after 2010. These findings identify a context-dependent association rather than a causal or universally optimal collaboration structure, demonstrating how regional scientific collaboration portfolios relate to the evolution of publicly disclosed knowledge trajectories.

Open PDF

---

2. Innovation adoption across regions: psychological openness and the early diffusion of digital platforms

Authors: Tobias Ebert, Martin Obschonka, Luca M. Aiello, Jeff Potter, P. Jason Rentfrow, Samuel D. Gosling

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105610 **Published**: 2027-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Innovation Studies, Economic Geography, Platform Economics, Behavioral Science
- **Theories**: Diffusion of Innovations, Network Effects, Big Five Personality Theory, Behavioral Geography

Abstract:

> Early regional adoption is crucial for platform-enabled innovations because their viability depends on enough people within a region adopting them to generate network effects. Existing research on regional innovation diffusion explains early adoption largely through demographic, economic, infrastructural, or institutional conditions, paying limited attention to regional population psychology. We conceptualize regional psychological openness as an invisible social infrastructure that is relevant for understanding early platform adoption. To test this idea, we introduce a newly curated dataset that allows us to trace the initial development of three major platform innovations (i.e., accommodation sharing platforms, ride-sharing platforms, social media platforms) across hundreds of U.S. metropolitan regions. Across all three platform types, regions differ markedly in early adoption. We link these adoption data to large-scale geo-referenced personality information from millions of U.S. residents (N = 3,234,899). Results show that regional psychological openness consistently predicts earlier uptake even after accounting for demographic, socio-economic, social, infrastructural, geographical, and other psychological characteristics. In sum, the study advances a behavioral perspective on regional innovation adoption by integrating population psychology into explanations of platform diffusion.

Open PDF

Volume 55, Issue 10 | Published 2026-12

1. Adoption survival frontiers: Artificial intelligence, financing frictions, and market structure

Authors: Dávid Zoltán Szabó, Péter Juhász

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105621 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Economics of Innovation, Industrial Organization, Corporate Finance
- **Theories**: Real Options Theory, Diffusion Theory, Industrial Organization Theory

Abstract:

> Artificial intelligence and other general-purpose digital technologies often diffuse unevenly: large firms adopt early, while smaller firms delay adoption, contract, or abandon the active adoption option. This paper develops a survival-constrained theory of technology adoption in which firms choose when to adopt an irreversible technology while financing operations under uncertain implementation costs. Abandonment/exit is endogenous: firms leave the active adoption race when the value of preserving the adoption option falls below the passive legacy fallback (the value of abandoning the active adoption option, normalized to zero). The key object is an adoption survival frontier, a boundary in financing-cost–implementation-uncertainty space separating environments in which followers survive long enough to adopt from environments in which they abandon the active adoption option first. The Cournot block disciplines the price-pass-through component of follower payoff erosion; additional non-price appropriability losses, captured by a reduced-form term χA (data accumulation, platform lock-in, switching frictions, and reduced access to post-adoption rents), remain reduced-form. Numerical characterization of the corrected nonhomogeneous stopping problem shows that a leader-induced regime shift moves the survival frontier inward and raises the risk that followers abandon the active adoption option before adoption. A welfare decomposition clarifies when this selection is efficient and when it reflects an accounting externality: a leader-induced payoff shift that the follower's private stopping problem does not represent before the regime shift. We do not solve a dynamic adoption-timing game. Public EU aggregate data show that large-minus-small AI adoption gaps are measurable, but also illustrate that aggregate cross-country regressions are confounded by development gradients and cannot identify the firm-level survival-to-adoption channel; we treat this as a measurement-feasibility map for future linked-microdata tests rather than as a test of the mechanism. The paper contributes a computational theory of adoption survival and a transparent measurement-feasibility map.

Open PDF

---

2. An (almost) free lunch? Symbolic recognition and knowledge-sharing behavior in online communities

Authors: Hyunwoo Park, Jeongsik (Jay) Lee

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105586 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Innovation Management, Organizational Behavior, Information Systems
- **Theories**: Self-Determination Theory, Social Exchange Theory, Signaling Theory

Abstract:

> How does symbolic recognition influence knowledge-sharing behavior in online communities? We investigate this question in the context of Stack Overflow, a large-scale, peer-curated platform for technical knowledge exchange. Exploiting the quasi-random timing of symbolic awards and employing a matched difference-in-differences design, we examine how contributors respond to the receipt of a peer-endorsed ''Nice Answer'' badge. We find a short-term increase in contribution volume and user engagement following the award. Over time, contributors expand into new and more distant knowledge domains, yet this broader participation is associated with a decline in contribution quality, particularly in unfamiliar areas. These findings reveal a temporal trade-off between content breadth and quality, offering behavioral insight into how symbolic incentives shape contributor effort and attention allocation. By isolating the effects of symbolic recognition in a setting free of material incentives, this study informs the design of reputation systems in online platforms and contributes to research on motivation, cognitive mobility, and knowledge production in digitally mediated communities.

Open PDF

---

3. Automation and employment over the technology life cycle: Evidence from European regions

Authors: Florencia Jaccoud, Fabien Petit, Tommaso Ciarli, Maria Savona

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105611 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Labor Economics, Economics of Innovation, Regional Science
- **Theories**: Technology Life Cycle Theory, Skill-Biased Technological Change, Routine-Biased Technological Change

Abstract:

> This paper examines how the labor market effects of automation and digital technologies vary across their technology life cycles. Using data for 158 European regions from 1995 to 2017, we study the phase-specific impacts of robots, information and communication technologies (ICT), and software and databases (SDB) on employment and wages. We identify distinct technology life cycles and their early and mature adoption phases by applying a structural break methodology to investment dynamics. To address endogeneity in regional exposure, we employ a shift-share instrumental-variable strategy that leverages US investment patterns interacted with pre-determined regional industrial structures. We find that labor market effects differ systematically across both technologies and life-cycle phases. Early adoption is skill-biased for intangible digital technologies: exposure to SDB during early diffusion is associated with declining employment and rising wages. In contrast, early ICT adoption is characterized by employment expansion concentrated among lower-paid workers, consistent with productivity-driven demand growth, while robots exhibit largely skill-neutral effects in early diffusion. For tangible technologies, displacement effects emerge in mature adoption phases. Across technologies, labor market adjustment operates mainly through the services sector, even when adoption occurs in manufacturing (robots). Our findings demonstrate that aggregate estimates of ICT and robots often mask opposing life cycle phase- and technology-specific dynamics.

Open PDF

---

4. Between expectations and outcomes: Technology adopters' narratives and technology discourse dynamics

Authors: Raluca Bunduchi, Marina Candi

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105622 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Science and Technology Studies, Innovation Management, Strategic Management
- **Theories**: Sociology of Expectations, Framing Theory, Sensemaking

Abstract:

> Expectations propel the evolution of emerging technologies, yet existing research generally assumes that expectations are gradually displaced by concrete outcomes as technologies mature and become widely accepted. We revisit this assumption by examining how technology adopters' temporal framings of technology performance, their expressions of concrete outcomes of technology adoption, and the broader technology discourse reflected in trade-press coverage relate to one another over time. We illuminate these patterns by tracing 21 years (2002–2022) of radio-frequency identification (RFID) adoption and analysing adopters' statements in 407 case stories published in The RFID Journal, coupled with a longitudinal corpus of trade-press coverage from the same period. Manual coding of adopters' expressions of concrete realised benefits and challenges in the case stories is combined with a purpose-built dictionary that detects five temporal positions in adopters' framings of RFID performance. We find that associations between concrete outcomes and temporal framings are selective and stage-dependent. Concrete outcomes do not simply replace expectations, instead, they become associated with specific temporal framings over time. We also find that adopters' temporal framings are associated with trade-press coverage in stage-specific ways that change over time, often amplifying but also sometimes tempering broader attention to RFID. We contribute to research on technology framing and expectations dynamics by foregrounding adopters as co-constructors of technology discourse, challenging the displacement assumption with a stage-sensitive explanation of expectation–outcome dynamics, and introducing a replicable, dictionary-based approach for large-scale analysis of temporal framings in technology narratives.

Open PDF

---

5. Bridging the gap: A scalable approach to measuring social innovation capacity

Authors: Johannes Carl, Nils Grashof, Matthias Menter

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105629 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Social Innovation, Regional Economics, Innovation Management
- **Theories**: Regional Innovation Systems, Capacity-Based View

Abstract:

> As governments increasingly turn to social innovation to address complex societal and environmental challenges, the lack of robust, scalable measurement frameworks continues to limit the effectiveness of relevant policies. Without such tools, it remains difficult to assess regional capacities, evaluate outcomes, and design targeted interventions that foster societal resilience and adaptability. This paper introduces a novel index of regional social innovation capacity, which is defined as a region's ability to develop, implement, and sustain social innovations. Drawing conceptually from the technological innovation literature, the index integrates multidimensional inputs for social innovation capacity using publicly available data and has been externally validated through an empirical analysis of social innovation activities published on German company websites. By employing regional planning areas as the unit of analysis, our framework enables cross-regional comparison while preserving local specificity. It also advances the measurability, visibility, and accountability of social innovation, offering policymakers an evidence-based tool for strategic resource allocation. From an academic perspective, the index bridges fragmented approaches across disciplines and contributes to a more coherent, comparative, policy-relevant social innovation research agenda.

Open PDF

---

6. Can artificial intelligence accelerate technological progress? Researchers' perspectives on AI in manufacturing and materials science

Authors: John P. Nelson, Olajide E. Olugbade, Philip Shapira, Justin B. Biddle

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105598 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Economics of Innovation, Science and Technology Studies, Innovation Management
- **Theories**: Technological Paradigms, Search and Discovery, Recombinant Innovation

Abstract:

> The use of artificial intelligence (AI) in research raises expectations of substantial increases in rates of technological progress, but such anticipations are often not connected to detailed ground-level studies of AI use in research processes. It therefore remains unclear how and under what conditions AI-enabled research can accelerate technological progress and innovation, and what limitations might apply. To address this gap, we analyzed results from 32 interviews with U.S.-based academic manufacturing and materials science researchers experienced with AI, including machine learning (ML) techniques (AI/ML). We found that, much like older computational tools, AI/ML was primarily used for modeling of materials and manufacturing processes, facilitating cheaper and more rapid search of design spaces for materials and manufacturing processes alike. Benefits included cost, time, and computational savings in technology development. However, AI/ML tools were unreliable outside design spaces for which dense data were already available; they required skilled and judicious application in tandem with older research techniques; and concerns were raised about the potential to detrimentally circumvent opportunities for disruptive theoretical advancement. Based on these results, we suggest there is reason for optimism about acceleration that sustains established technological paradigms through the use of AI/ML. However, support for conventional empirical, computational, and theoretical research is required to enhance the likelihood of further disruptive advances in manufacturing and materials.

Open PDF

---

7. Combining digital and green technologies in regions: How to close the gap with respect to the frontier?

Authors: Stefano Basilico, Alberto Marzucchi, Sandro Montresor

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105636 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Economic Geography, Regional Economics, Innovation Studies
- **Theories**: Evolutionary Economic Geography, Knowledge Recombination, Technological Frontier

Abstract:

> This paper focuses on the combination of green and digital technologies at the regional level. Using patent data, we put forward an original measurement of the regional speed of a new green-digital (i.e. twin) combination: the temporal distance between the time at which a combination is realised for the first time in the frontier region and the time at which this same combination is accomplished in the focal region. We proceed by investigating the drivers and the technological impact related to this speed. We find that the speed of combination is enhanced by dealing with broad twin technologies and by recombining more diverse prior knowledge to do that. The speed at which the gap is closed, also crucially depends on the interdependencies between green and digital local domains, captured by the overlap in their regional knowledge bases. Counterintuitively, the longer their combination paths, the faster regions combine green and digital technologies. Finally, we find that the earlier the first regional green-digital combinations happen, the greater is their impact on subsequent inventions, while the impact of all regional green-digital combinations is apparently lower. Overall, these results are discussed in terms of policy recommendations, given the high attention placed by policymakers on the twin transition.

Open PDF

---

8. Contested credibility: Public perceptions of scientists as experts

Authors: Anders Broström, Cornelia Lawson, Mabel Sanchez-Barrioluengo

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105640 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Science Communication, Sociology of Science, Public Understanding of Science
- **Theories**: Source Credibility Model, Social Contract of Science, Trust in Science

Abstract:

> Science is widely embraced as an important prerequisite for innovation, and there is widespread support for public investment in science on that basis. However, it remains more contested whether and when science is recognized as a relevant source of expertise in contemporary debates beyond the academic sphere. Drawing on nationally representative survey panels from two European countries (the United Kingdom and Sweden), we investigate whether scientists are perceived as more credible senders of messages regarding societal challenges compared with attribution to other types of expert groups (government, businesspersons, and issue advocates). Evidence from a conjoint analysis paints a rather bleak picture: scientists' credibility is only superior to that of government officials, but not businesspersons or issue advocates. We furthermore find that scientists are more credible when communicating technological issues than non-technological ones. This pattern can be traced back to three types of perceived sources of distrust (vested interest, partisanship and irrelevance) that are activated more strongly for non-technological issues. The same three sources of distrust also underpin the general credibility disadvantage of scientists as experts. Implications for our understanding of the social contract of science are discussed.

Open PDF

---

9. Dynamic platform strategies in an interconnected ecosystem: Navigating standards and complements in the emerging smart home ecosystem

Authors: Hans Berends, Fleur Deken, Jochem T. Hummel

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105609 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Strategic Management, Innovation Management
- **Theories**: Platform Theory, Ecosystem Theory, Standardization Theory

Abstract:

> Whereas prior platform research has mostly assumed standardized interfaces that are platform-specific, we examine how platform strategies based on third-party standards have become prevalent in a nascent ecosystem. Based on a longitudinal analysis of 97 smart home platforms, we analyze the value creation and capture benefits of four platform modes defined by two dimensions: the source of complements (first- or third-party complements) and the standardized interfaces used to connect these complements (first- or third-party standards). Our analysis demonstrates a trend from closed strategies (only first-party complements based on first-party standards) towards strategies that (also) rely on third-party standards. We find that startups and diversifying entrants make different strategic choices at entry and that firms increasingly combine platform modes over time to leverage their distinct value creation and capture benefits. Our findings contribute insights into the ecosystem conditions and pre-entry capabilities of firms under which strategies relying on third-party standards become viable and how this contributes to the proliferation of standards, platforms, and strategies in an ecosystem. We also theorize the time-dependent strategic choices of entrants navigating a nascent ecosystem and the complex complementary and competitive relations that emerge in an ecosystem with interconnected platforms as a result.

Open PDF

---

10. Firms' board diversity and radical innovation: mediation mechanism of firms' attention to digital transformation

Authors: Wan Cheng, Jingyu Li, Li Liu

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105627 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Corporate Governance, Strategic Management, Innovation Management
- **Theories**: Attention-Based View, Information Processing Theory, Upper Echelons Theory

Abstract:

> This study integrates board information processing theory with the attention-based view to examine how board diversity affects radical innovation through an organizational attention pathway. We argue that board diversity shapes firms' attention to digital transformation (FADT), which in turn promotes radical innovation, and that industry competition conditions this process by heightening the urgency of attending to digital opportunities. Using longitudinal data from 2556 publicly listed Chinese firms from 2008 to 2019, we find that board diversity has an inverted U-shaped relationship with FADT and that FADT positively affects radical innovation. FADT thus mediates the inverted U-shaped relationship between board diversity and radical innovation, producing an inverted U-shaped indirect effect. Industry competition strengthens the relationship between board diversity and FADT, making this indirect effect more pronounced in competitive environments. These findings clarify how board diversity contributes to radical innovation by directing organizational attention toward digital transformation and show why moderate diversity is especially valuable when firms face strong competitive pressure.

Open PDF

---

11. From academic lab to spinoff: How opportunity beliefs evolve from individual to venture during technology-market matching

Authors: Anurag Wasnik, Einar Rasmussen, Jon Thomas, Elicia Maine

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105585 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Entrepreneurship, Innovation Management, Organizational Behavior
- **Theories**: Cognitive Perspective, Organizational Learning, Sensemaking, Cognitive Dissonance Theory

Abstract:

> Academic labs are central to the creation of radical-generic technologies. Yet translating these inventions into successful innovations poses a significant challenge as academic scientists often struggle to identify and prioritize viable markets in the early stages of commercialization. This study examines how individual scientists' opportunity beliefs evolve into the shared commercialization strategy of an academic spinoff. Using a longitudinal single-case study of the technology-market matching (TMM) process of a radical-generic technology, we analyze individual and team assessments of eight technology-market combinations over 15 years. We show that opportunity beliefs evolve from an initial emphasis on functional aspects of structural similarity toward an increasing emphasis on commercial viability, eventually integrating balanced similarity considerations. Within TMM, three mechanisms – productive cognitive dissonance, expanded similarity awareness, and team reflexivity – explain how heterogeneous individual beliefs evolve and coalesce into the commercialization strategy of the spinoff. We introduce "simmering-with-the-lab" as an organizational strategy through which latent technology-market options are maintained in the academic lab while the spinoff pursues a narrower set of commercial opportunities. The study advances theory on TMM and organizational learning for deep tech academic spinoffs and has practical implications for science entrepreneurship training, innovation policy, and university IP strategy.

Open PDF

---

12. From impact to legitimacy: Communicative responsibility and the governance of research impact

Authors: Philippa Hunter-Jones, Michael Haenlein

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105639 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Science Policy, Research Management, Public Communication of Science
- **Theories**: Legitimacy Theory, Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI), Governance Theory

Abstract:

> Universities face growing pressure to make clearer the public value of research, yet documented impact does not automatically translate into public recognition or legitimacy. This paper develops the concept of Communicative Responsibility, the institutional and ethical obligation to communicate research outcomes in ways that are legible, accessible, and resonant beyond specialist assessment contexts. Drawing on responsible research literatures, including Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) and Responsible Research in Business and Management (RRBM), we argue that communication should be treated as a core component of research governance and legitimacy. Empirically, we use the UK Research Excellence Framework (REF) 2021 Impact Database to examine the communicative strengths and limitations of existing impact evidence. REF impact case studies are not the only way to understand research impact, nor are they primarily written for public audiences. However, they offer a useful proxy for examining how impact might be perceived and how it could be shared more effectively. Using mixed methods, we combine qualitative content analysis of 119 purposively sampled Business and Management cases with quantitative text analysis of all 504 non-redacted cases in the field. Findings show diverse impacts generated through collaboration, interdisciplinarity, and international partnerships, but also substantial variation in communicability. Cases that identify beneficiaries, pathways to change, and accessible dissemination routes are better positioned to reduce the impact-recognition gap. We contribute to theorizing Communicative Responsibility as a governance-relevant extension of responsible research. Our findings have wider implications for how universities communicate impact beyond assessment systems.

Open PDF

---

13. How to craft a mission? A Theory of Action for the strategic public management of mission-oriented innovation policy

Authors: Iacopo Gronchi

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105631 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Innovation Policy, Strategic Public Management, Institutional Theory
- **Theories**: Mission-Oriented Innovation Policy, Institutional Work, Institutional Logics, Theory of Action

Abstract:

> This paper explores the role of strategic public management within mission-oriented innovation policy. While recent scholarship has emphasised multiple aspects of missions, the distinct relevance of strategic public management in their implementation remains under-explored. To address this gap, the paper performs two complementary tasks. First, it uses a qualitative meta-synthesis of the relevant innovation literature to articulate a new Theory of Action for the analysis of missioncraft: namely, the institutional work public managers perform to create or maintain (disrupt) institutional logics supporting (hinder) their effective implementation. Second, it leverages a pre-study of the extant literature to illustrate the Theory of Action with three historical vignettes showing how the ToA can be applied at different scales and under different institutional logics (US' DARPA; China's NEV Plan programme; and EU's RIS3). Overall, the paper argues that the implementation of mission-oriented innovation policy requires public managers to adopt three critical strategic roles: i) enabling strategic learning across the public sector organisations leading the mission; ii) enabling dynamic accountability in the portfolio of projects supported by the mission; and iii) enabling collaborative innovation among the societal actors partaking the mission. By shifting the focus on the micro-foundations of mission implementation from structural underpinnings (i.e., legal, organisational, managerial) to agentic functions (i.e., strategic roles), the paper provides a new diagnostic lens for innovation policy research and practice – reflecting whether and how public managers can support mission-oriented innovation policy in light of the context-specific opportunities and constraints they face in their institutional work.

Open PDF

---

14. Local implementation of transformative innovation policies: Ambiguities, strategic responses, and intertemporal conflicts

Authors: Brittney (Britt) Regal, Damian Grimshaw, Marcela Miozzo, Jonatan Pinkse

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105624 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Innovation Policy, Sustainability Transitions, Public Administration
- **Theories**: Transformative Innovation Policy, Institutional Ambiguity, Conflict Theory

Abstract:

> Transformative Innovation Policy (TIP) offers a compelling framework for addressing societal challenges. However, its implementation requires a deeper understanding of the behavioural and relational dynamics among local actors because these dynamics can enable or hinder sustainable and inclusive policy outcomes. Drawing on an embedded case study of the implementation of residential electric vehicle charging infrastructure in England, we unveil how the interplay between policy ambiguities and emergent conflicts conditions the local pathways of TIP implementation. We show that local actors respond to ambiguities of role, means, and resourcing, and that these responses can shape three conflicts (purpose incongruence, commons contestation, and financial fragility) which evolve over time. Building on these insights, we develop a model of local TIP implementation that explains how implementing actors respond to ambiguities and how these responses shape conflicts. Overall, our analysis contributes to understanding the intertemporal and distributive challenges facing TIP implementation.

Open PDF

---

15. Measuring the production of scientific human capital: New data, methods, and evidence on the U.S. scientific training ecosystem

Authors: Dror Shvadron, Hansen Zhang, Lee Fleming, Daniel P. Gross

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105605 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Economics of Science, Science and Technology Policy, Labor Economics
- **Theories**: Human Capital Theory, Public Goods Theory

Abstract:

> We develop a dissertation-based methodology for measuring PhD populations and use it to present new evidence on who funds STEM PhD training in the United States, how many graduates are trained in areas of strategic national importance, and the effects of public investment in PhD training on PhD production. The U.S. government is by far the largest source of financial and in-kind support for STEM PhD training in America. We identify universities and fields where PhD training has high rates of government, industry, or philanthropic support, and the organizations and universities that fund and train the most PhDs in critical technology areas such as AI, quantum science, and biotechnology. Leveraging variation in government support across agencies and over time, we provide evidence suggesting that increasing government-funded PhD trainees increases PhD production additively or with modest crowd-in. To support further research, we provide public data at multiple levels of aggregation. These data and methods complement existing data collection efforts by national statistics agencies, producing information which is otherwise hard to collect or not systematically observed, and can be extended forward in time and to other countries.

Open PDF

---

16. Old and connected versus young and creative: Networks and the diffusion of new scientific ideas

Authors: Wei Cheng, Bruce A. Weinberg

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105628 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Sociology of Science, Economics of Science, Network Science
- **Theories**: Diffusion of Innovation, Social Network Theory

Abstract:

> The adoption of new ideas is essential for progress and involves innovators, potential adopters, and their networks. We apply natural language processing, network analysis, and a novel fixed effects strategy to study how career age affects idea adoption in coauthorship networks in biomedical science. At short network distances (≤3 steps away), young innovators' ideas are adopted the most while, at greater distances, mid-career innovators' ideas have the highest adoption. The main reason for this contrast is that young potential adopters are disproportionately likely to adopt new ideas introduced by nearby young innovators. Simulations show that the aging of innovators and of potential adopters have comparable effects on the adoption of important new ideas.

Open PDF

---

17. Public views on the use of AI in scientific research

Authors: Christian Bretter, Boryana Todorova, Caitlin Curtis, Matthew J. Hornsey

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105632 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Science and Technology Studies, Public Understanding of Science, AI Governance
- **Theories**: Legitimacy Theory, Trust in Science

Abstract:

> Generative AI tools are becoming common in scientific work, yet little is known about how the public – the taxpayers who fund much of this research – view their use. In a preregistered, nationally representative UK survey (N = 1465), we find that the public attitudes towards AI-assisted research are nuanced: While most respondents support public funding for scientific research in general (77%), support falls sharply when generative AI is involved (42%). This AI funding penalty is strongest among scientifically literate, politically liberal, younger, and female respondents. Moreover, 34–40% say they would trust both the science and the scientists less if generative AI was used during research. At the same time, a majority (83–85%) support scientists' use of generative AI when substantial human input is retained. Results suggest ambivalence about the use of AI as a scientific tool, findings that have direct implications for how AI-assisted research is governed, disclosed, and ultimately judged legitimate.

Open PDF

---

18. Research grant effects across funding modes and industry collaboration

Authors: Stefano Baruffaldi, Felicia Jorzick, Cornelia Lawson

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105623 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Economics of Science, Science Policy, Innovation Studies
- **Theories**: Principal-Agent Theory, Resource-Based View

Abstract:

> The impact of public research funding remains debated, with limited evidence on how effects differ across funding modes. As funders are contemplating different instruments to support research and development, we provide causal evidence on the impact of a major UK funder and use this setting to explore how its effects vary across grant features. We implement a regression discontinuity design using novel data on more than 2000 applications evaluated by the Engineering and Physical Sciences Research Council (EPSRC). We study the causal effect and examine differences between open, investigator-initiated schemes— characterised by greater researcher autonomy in defining research questions—and directional, funder-initiated schemes—which direct efforts towards predefined priorities. We further explore heterogeneities in how industry collaboration interacts with these funding modes. Our results show that investigator-initiated grants are associated with stronger subsequent performance advantage for funded researchers, but only when projects remain academically embedded. Directional grants, instead, exhibit more positive effects when combined with industry collaboration. While on average research grants have a substantial positive impact in our setting, their effects vary across key features, informing debates on the design of public science funding systems and highlighting the need for further research on the interplay between different funding characteristics.

Open PDF

---

19. The wisdom of the diverse crowd(funders)

Authors: Hadar Gafni, Lars Bo Jeppesen

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105612 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Entrepreneurial Finance, Behavioral Economics, Crowdfunding
- **Theories**: Wisdom of Crowds, Information Asymmetry, Prosocial Motivation

Abstract:

> Crowdfunding platforms aim to democratize entrepreneurial finance by creating ecosystems that elicit the 'wisdom of crowds'—aggregating the judgments of individual and often amateur funders. However, there is limited evidence on whether crowds can effectively apply their collective wisdom on these platforms. We address this gap by analyzing MyC4, a crowdlending platform that connects Western lenders with borrowers in developing countries. We examine whether lenders effectively screen borrowers, identify platform attributes that influence lenders' screening accuracy, and uncover the underlying mechanisms driving these effects. Empirically, we leverage platform-initiated 'top-up' funding by MyC4 administrators, which allows us to observe the counterfactual repayment performance of loans that would otherwise have remained unfunded, enabling us to evaluate lenders' screening ability against an otherwise unobservable benchmark. Our results indicate that crowdlenders can effectively screen creditworthy borrowers, but only when financial information about borrowers is made available. Lenders' screening effectiveness diminishes substantially for prosocial loans, as many funders converge on similar, socially motivated decisions. These findings provide novel evidence on crowdlenders' performance, highlighting key trade-offs for crowdfunding platforms and offering actionable insights for their administrators.

Open PDF

---

20. Towards a theory of industrial modernity

Authors: Laur Kanger, Aro Velmet, Liina Maurer, Anna Helena Liiv, Phil Johnstone

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105625 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Sustainability Transitions, Economic History, Science and Technology Studies
- **Theories**: Deep Transitions Framework, Multi-Level Perspective, Institutional Theory

Abstract:

> The deepening socio-environmental polycrisis has stimulated calls to rethink industrial modernity: the currently dominant societal assumptions about the natural environment, science and technology. However, the genesis and long-term co-evolution of these deep macro-level assumptions has rarely gained systematic attention in innovation studies. This is an important oversight given that the historical legacy of industrial modernity continues to shape the policy framing of current sustainability challenges as well as the design of appropriate interventions. In this paper we seek to develop a conceptual vocabulary for theorizing the historical evolution of industrial modernity. Combining the Deep Transitions framework from sustainability transitions studies with insights on long-term industrialization-related trends from various fields, we 1) present a systematically validated inventory of 38 constituent ideas, institutions and practices of industrial modernity; 2) map their emergence over the past 250 years; 3) identify 10 recurrent controversial outcomes generated by the interactions of these traits; 4) distinguish between three phases in the long-term evolution of industrial modernity. We conclude with a research agenda for studying the historical evolution, current impacts and policy implications of industrial modernity.

Open PDF

---

21. Towards mission theory: A systematic literature review of its critiques and avenues for progress (2010–2025)

Authors: Iacopo Gronchi, Josh Entsminger

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105634 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Innovation Policy, Science and Technology Studies, Economic Sociology
- **Theories**: Mission-Oriented Innovation Policy, Evolutionary Economics, Institutional Theory

Abstract:

> During the last 15 years, researchers and practitioners alike showed a newfound interest in the potential of 'mission-oriented' innovation policy to tackle current societal challenges. In this period, the approach prompted multiple reflections and critiques from orthodox and heterodox scholars alike. However, a structured appraisal of this debate has been missing. Untangling its analytical complexity, this paper presents a systematic literature review of 224 articles and book chapters published between 2010 and 2025 to appraise the state-of-the-art debate within 'mission theory'. Using the PRISMA Protocol and abductive thematic analysis, the paper identifies 18 themes mapped across two analytical dimensions: positioning (identifying either 'external' challenges or 'internal' gaps within mission theory); and layering (identifying challenges and gaps based on a 'foundational', 'theoretical', or 'empirical' ground). Building on the findings, the paper reflects on the sociological conditions preventing the progress of mission theory in contemporary research efforts – ultimately calling for greater epistemological reflexivity in the strategies adopted by researchers and practitioners to develop avenues for its further progress.

Open PDF

---

22. Training and productivity in micro-firms

Authors: Marco Rispoli, Federico Tamagni

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105637 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Entrepreneurship, Labor Economics, Small Business Management
- **Theories**: Human Capital Theory, Resource-Based View

Abstract:

> This paper examines the effect of training on productivity of micro-firms, defined in official statistics as firms with less than 10 employees. While training may represent a crucial mode of knowledge accumulation in micro-firms, which usually lack resources

> or structure to devote to formal innovation activities, the specificities of micro-businesses suggest that training may even be detrimental to productivity of this category of firms. Yet, the received wisdom that training should foster their productivity, as it does in larger firms, remains untested, mainly due to difficulties in previous literature to analyze micro-firms separately from the wider groups of small or small-medium enterprises. Exploiting a unique administrative panel dataset that records training expenses of a large sample of micro-firms located in three Italian regions, we address whether micro-firms which train enjoy a productivity premium vis-a-vis micro-firms that do not. Our main finding, controlling for endogeneity of training via Inverse Probability Weighted Regression Adjustment methods, combined with firm fixed-effects, is a positive and sizable average treatment effect of training, stable across a series of robustness checks and heterogeneity analysis.

Open PDF

---

23. Who receives R&D tax incentives? Firm capabilities and stage-dependent access

Authors: Manuel Chu, Sergio Afcha, Ivet M. del-Sol-Alonso

DOI: 10.1016/j.respol.2026.105635 **Published**: 2026-12

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields**: Innovation Policy, Public Economics, Strategic Management
- **Theories**: Resource-Based View, Dynamic Capabilities

Abstract:

> This paper examines which firms are able to access and progress through Colombia's R&D tax-benefit scheme. Using firm-level microdata from three waves of the Colombian Manufacturing Innovation Survey, we estimate sequential logit models to assess how firm capabilities are associated with progression from intention to apply, to application, and ultimately to receipt. The results reveal a clear stage-dependent pattern. General innovation capabilities—including R&D effort, internal innovation resources, information-source breadth, export orientation, and university cooperation—are most strongly associated with firms' initial intention to apply. Conditional on intention, progression to application is more closely related to organizational scale and university cooperation. Conditional on application, receipt is less consistently associated with broad innovation effort, while the stage-specific analysis provides only suggestive evidence of associations with more specific organizational and relational characteristics. Additional analyses indicate that exposure to other forms of public innovation support is associated primarily with initial engagement rather than with progression at later stages. These findings suggest that formal eligibility does not translate automatically into effective access to R&D tax incentives. This implies that evaluations of tax incentives should account for the selective processes that precede receipt. For policymakers, the results indicate that broad-based fiscal incentives may need to be complemented by stage-specific information, administrative assistance, and capability-building measures if access is to extend beyond firms already equipped to navigate the scheme.

Open PDF
